

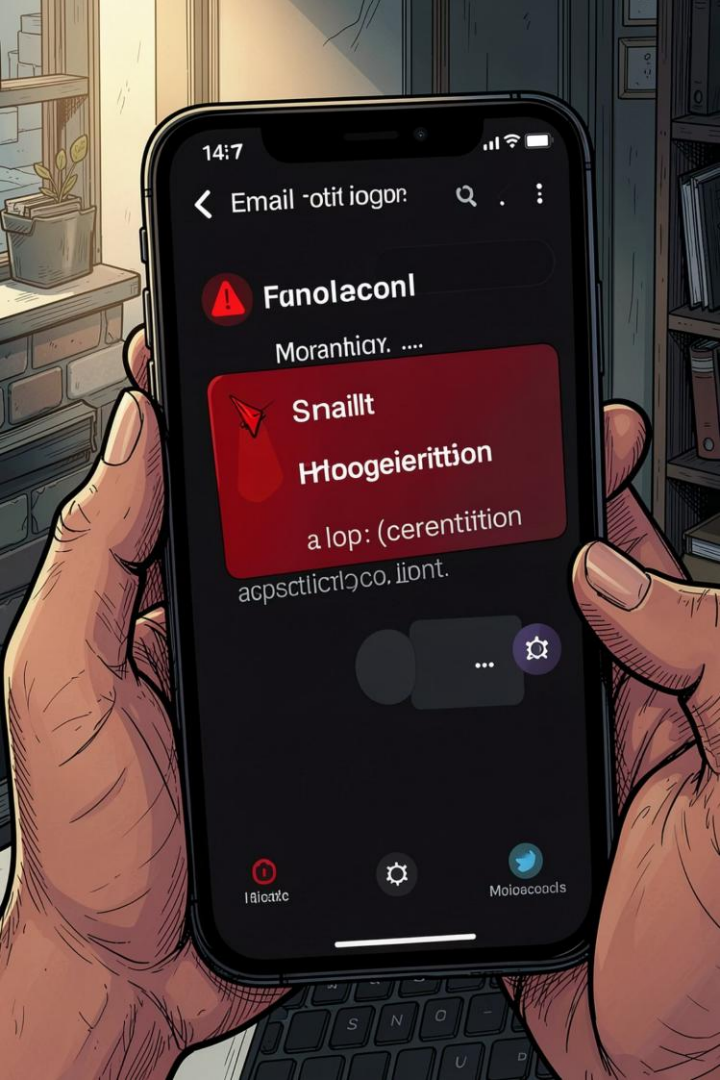


Student Phishing Scenarios

Three real-world phishing stories set at Coventry University and CU London — testing your ability to spot scams, protect your account, and make the right choice under pressure.

CYBERSECURITY AWARENESS

INTERACTIVE SCENARIOS



Scenario 1: Urgent Assignment Re-upload Scam

You're a 2nd-year Coventry student. After submitting coursework on Turnitin, you receive an urgent email: "Re-upload by 11:59PM or receive zero marks."

▶ Red Flags

- Fake domain: `coventry-unl-support.co.uk`
- Threatening language & pressure to act
- Suspicious shortened link

✓ Correct Choice (+25 pts)

Open official Turnitin directly and check submission status yourself.

✗ Wrong Choices

Clicking the link steals login details (-15 pts). Replying confirms your email is active (-5 pts).

Scenario 2: Fake IT Support Password Reset



During a busy semester, you receive an email from "Coventry University IT Support": **"FINAL WARNING: Password Expiring Today — reset within 3 hours or lose access."**

- ✓ **Correct (+25 pts):** Verify via official Coventry IT support page.
- ✗ **Wrong (-20 pts):** Clicking the link steals your credentials.

▶ Red Flags

- Fake site: `coventry-passwordhelp.net`
- Generic greeting: "Dear Student"
- Fear tactics & unofficial link



Scenario 3: Fake Tuition Fee Refund Scam

A CU London student receives an SMS: "Your tuition fee was processed twice. Claim your £5,000 refund now."

Red Flags

- Unknown mobile number
- Suspicious repayment link
- Requests bank details
- Urgency & excitement tactics

✓ Correct Choice (+30 pts)

Check the official university finance portal directly.

✗ Wrong Choices

Clicking steals banking info (-25 pts). Replying confirms your number is active (-5 pts).

Key Learning Objectives



Spot Fake Emails

Check sender domains carefully — fake addresses often mimic official ones with slight variations.



Resist Urgency Tactics

Scammers use fear and deadlines to rush you. Pause and verify before acting.



Detect Phishing Links

Never click links in urgent messages. Always navigate to official websites directly.



Protect Your Credentials

Universities never request passwords or bank details via email or SMS links.



Stay Safe — The Golden Rules

1 Verify through official channels

Always access university services via trusted, bookmarked websites — never through email links.

2 Never share credentials

No legitimate university service will ask for your password or bank details via message.

3 Report suspicious messages

If in doubt, contact your university's IT support directly before taking any action.